



STARTUP TACTICS · PROVING PERSONA ASSUMPTIONS WITH DIGITAL ADVERTISING

PROVE IT BEFORE WE SCALE IT.

Team NBC (Next Billion Children)

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Fall 2026 · Tactic week Wed 7 – Tue 13 Oct 2026 · Campaign designed; launches Wed 14 Oct

[Full brand guide \(PDF\)](#) · [All campaign files on GitHub](#)

THE VENTURE

ANSWERS ARE CHEAP. TRYING AGAIN IS NOT.

AI makes answers cheap, but the chance for children to investigate, build, get it wrong and try again is still costly. NBC builds **programmable physical learning environments where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI**, starting from five years of Algo Peers practice in Cape Coast, Ghana.

FIRST CUSTOMER

People who run after-school and holiday programmes for children aged about 9–12.

THE OFFER

Learning Worlds: reusable physical experiences, facilitator guidance and a short evidence summary.

STAGE

Pre-seed. Algo Peers has reached 1,000+ children; NBC pilots start this term.

THE BRIEF

FIND OUT WHO LEANS IN, BEFORE WE SPEND ON EVERYONE.



EASE SELLS TO OWNERS.

Programme owners respond more to "ready to run" than to "evidence you can show".



EDUCATORS WANT TO CO-BUILD.

Teachers and facilitators respond to an invitation to design the first version with us.



PARENTS WANT AGENCY, NOT SCORES.

Parents respond to "let them get it wrong, then try again".



THE DIASPORA WILL SPONSOR.

Ghanaians abroad register interest in sponsoring a learning room.

The experiment: five ads to four personas on Meta and LinkedIn, each with a matching landing page. Two one-week rounds, \$200 in total. We keep the persona and message that bring qualified sign-ups at the lowest cost.

DESIGNED • LAUNCHES WED 14 OCT

01

THE WAY IN

Our go-to-market for the first months: three doors, one pilot. This week's meetings open two of them; the ads test the third.

THREE DOORS. ONE PILOT.

DOOR 1 · THE SYSTEM

PERMISSION AND REACH

- Met Ghana's Minister of Communication and Digital Innovation (Harvard Kennedy School)
- Exploring an MOU with GES Cape Coast to co-build with educators
- Meeting Dr Ekwow Spio-Garbrah, former Minister of Education (being scheduled)

DOOR 2 · THE ECOSYSTEM

MENTORS, CAPITAL, CREDIBILITY

- Meeting Jeff D. Davis, director of Utah's Master of Business Creation, which runs a founder cohort in Ghana (Tue 6 Oct)
- TNT accelerator: decision pending
- Navab Social Innovation Fellowship: interview

DOOR 3 · DIRECT DEMAND

PROOF THAT PEOPLE WANT IT

- Five persona ads with four landing pages (this tactic)
- 10 watering holes and 10 interviews (last tactic)
- Pilot offers to 10 programme owners by Tue 20 Oct

EVERY MEETING HAS A JOB.

WHO	ITS JOB	WHAT IT CHANGES IN THE CAMPAIGN	STATUS
Jeff D. Davis Director, Master of Business Creation, University of Utah; led its founder cohort in Ghana; 23 years building brands at P&G	Pressure-test the five ads and the pilot offer before launch; explore MBC Global	Creative review on Tue 6 Oct, before any money is spent	TUE 6 OCT
Dr Ekwow Spio-Garbrah Former Minister of Education and of Communication; first African CEO of the Commonwealth Telecommunications Organisation; Special Envoy for Reparations	Advice on working with GES and the Ministry; introductions to diaspora partners	Shapes the sponsor persona (A5) and the educator invitation (A3)	THIS WEEK

EVERY MEETING HAS A JOB.

WHO	ITS JOB	WHAT IT CHANGES IN THE CAMPAIGN	STATUS
GES Cape Coast Director met by our Ghana team; MOU for pilot testing being explored	Co-build the first version with educators	We share the educator ad (A3) with GES before it runs	EXPLORING
Ministry of Communication and Digital Innovation Minister met at the Harvard Kennedy School	Align with Ghana’s digital agenda	Our message: built in Ghana, with Ghana’s educators	MET

GO-TO-MARKET · SEQUENCE

PROVE. PILOT. THEN GROW.

OCTOBER

PROVE THE PERSONA

Ads, interviews and watering holes show which buyer and message pull hardest.

Pass: one persona hits our pass lines

NOVEMBER

PILOT WITH PERMISSION

An MOU with GES Cape Coast; 3 paying programme owners; educators co-design version one.

Pass: 3 of 10 offers paid by Tue 10 Nov

DEC - JAN

GROW BY TRUST

Educator networks, referrals from first programmes, and diaspora sponsors for rooms that cannot pay.

Pass: repeat use and referrals

THE PEOPLE

Four personas. Each comes with an assumption we can prove wrong.

PERSONAS

WHO WE THINK WILL LEAN IN.

BUYER

THE PROGRAMME OWNER

Runs an after-school or holiday programme in Cape Coast or Accra; 25–60; pays for materials and staff.

WE ASSUME

Wants sessions that run without the one expert, and something to show parents and funders.

PROVED IF

Books a pilot conversation from A1 or A2.

USER · CO-DESIGNER

THE EDUCATOR

Teacher or facilitator in Ghana; 22–55; science, ICT or a coding club.

WE ASSUME

Will give time to co-design if it is practical and credits their work.

PROVED IF

Joins the co-design group from A3.

PAYER · INFLUENCER

THE PARENT

Parent of a child aged 8–12 in Cape Coast; 25–50.

WE ASSUME

Values seeing how their child tackles a challenge over scores.

PROVED IF

Asks for a programme near them from A4.

FUNDER

THE DIASPORA SPONSOR

Ghanaian abroad (US, UK, Canada); alumni associations; professionals.

WE ASSUME

Will sponsor a learning room at home if reporting is honest.

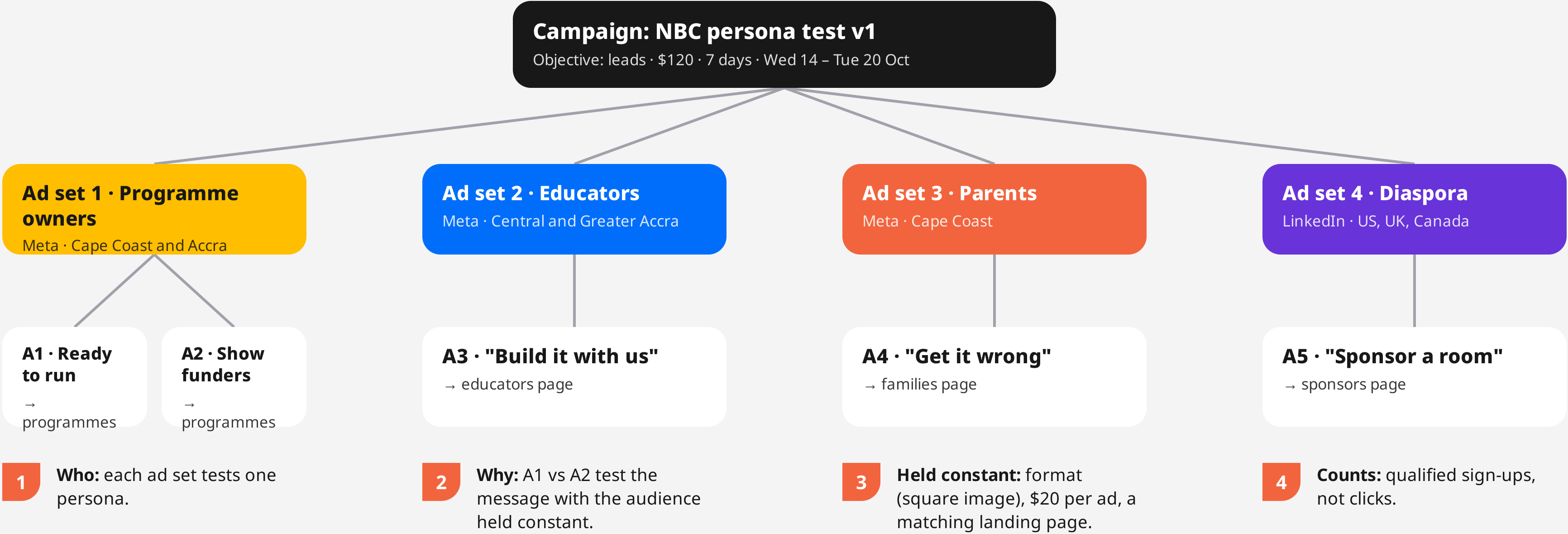
PROVED IF

Registers interest from A5.

THE EXPERIMENT

One campaign, four audiences, five messages. Each split tests a single thing.

ONE CAMPAIGN. FIVE QUESTIONS.



WHAT EACH AD TESTS.

AD	PERSONA (WHO)	MESSAGE (WHY)	LANDING PAGE	PLACEMENT	BUDGET
A1	Programme owner	Ease: "ready to run"	Programmes	Meta feed	\$20 · 7 days
A2	Programme owner	Evidence: "show funders"	Programmes	Meta feed	\$20 · 7 days
A3	Educator	Co-creation: "build it with us"	Educators	Meta feed	\$20 · 7 days
A4	Parent	Agency: "get it wrong, try again"	Families	Meta feed	\$20 · 7 days
A5	Diaspora sponsor	Belonging: "a room at home"	Sponsors	LinkedIn feed	\$20 · 7 days

Our pass lines (set in advance; ours, not industry benchmarks): link click rate of 1% or more on Meta and 0.5% or more on LinkedIn; 5% or more of landing-page visitors sign up; qualified sign-ups at \$10 or less each.

THE ADS

Five ads, designed in the brand. Each one speaks to one person and sends them to a page made for them.

HANDS-ON LEARNING, READY TO RUN



Next Billion Children
Sponsored · preview mockup

Run a 45-minute hands-on session from one printed card. Learning Worlds give y...



FOR PROGRAMME OWNERS

**HANDS-ON
LEARNING,
READY TO RUN.**

Learning Worlds for after-school and holiday programmes · ages 9-12

[Book a pilot conversation](#)

Hands-on learning, ready to run

[Book now](#)

PERSONA	Programme owners
PLACEMENT	Meta (Facebook and Instagram) feed
PRIMARY TEXT	Run a 45-minute hands-on session from one printed card. Learning Worlds give your programme reusable kits, facilitator guidance and a short evidence summary. Pilots open in Cape Coast.
HEADLINE · CTA	Hands-on learning, ready to run · Book now
LANDS ON	programmes page · utm_content=a1



What it tests: Ease: is "ready to run" the reason owners click?

SHOW FUNDERS WHAT CHILDREN CAN DO



Next Billion Children

Sponsored · preview mockup

Funders and parents ask what children are learning. Learning Worlds come with ...



FOR PROGRAMME OWNERS

SHOW FUNDERS WHAT CHILDREN CAN REALLY DO.

A short evidence summary with every Learning World · no scores

Book a pilot conversation

Show funders what children can do

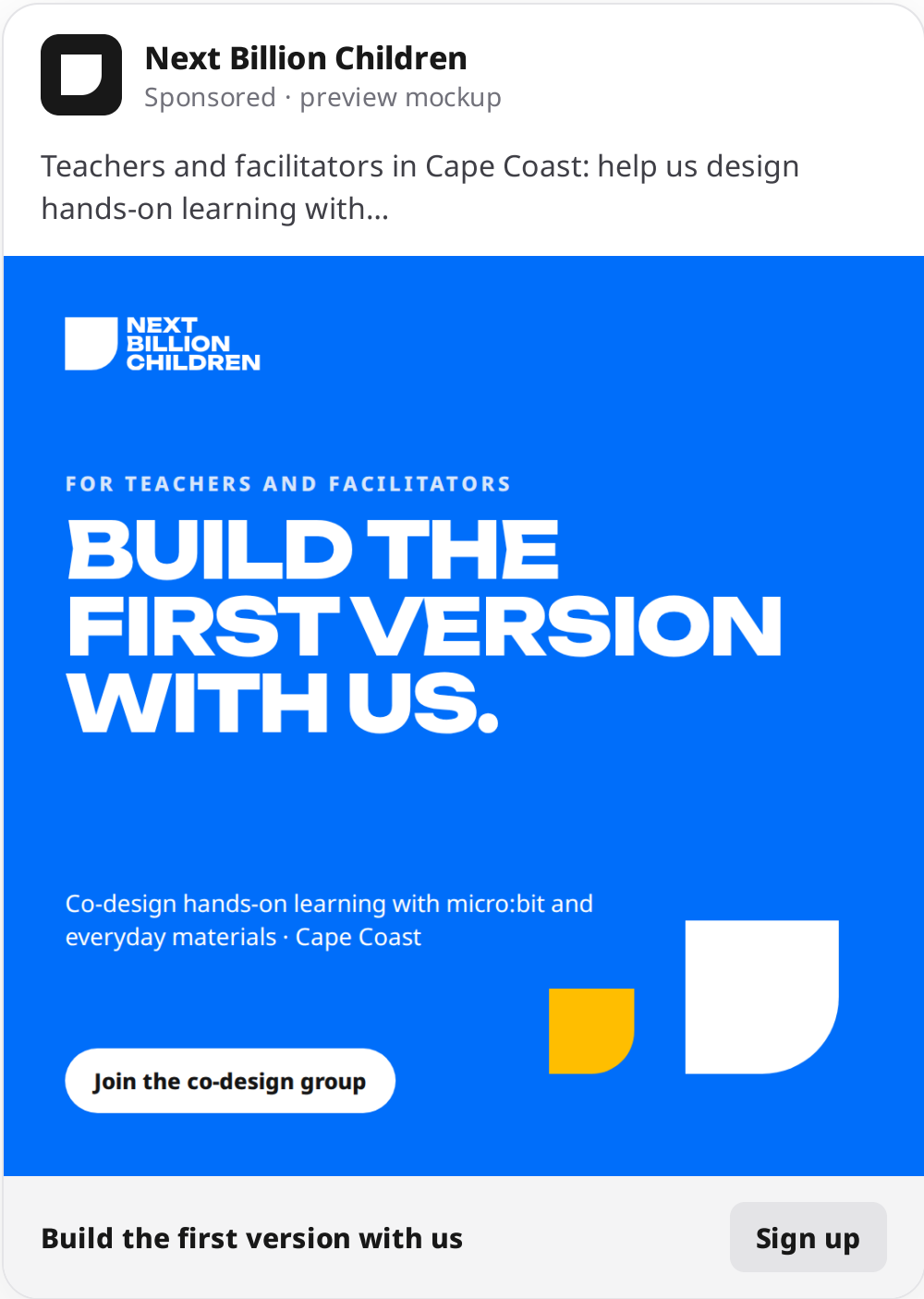
Book now

PERSONA	Programme owners
PLACEMENT	Meta (Facebook and Instagram) feed
PRIMARY TEXT	Funders and parents ask what children are learning. Learning Worlds come with a short evidence summary: what each child tried, how much help they had, and whether it held. No scores.
HEADLINE · CTA	Show funders what children can do · Book now
LANDS ON	programmes page · utm_content=a2



What it tests: Evidence: does proof beat ease for the same audience?

BUILD THE FIRST VERSION WITH US



PERSONA	Educators
PLACEMENT	Meta (Facebook and Instagram) feed
PRIMARY TEXT	Teachers and facilitators in Cape Coast: help us design hands-on learning with micro:bit and everyday materials. Join a small co-design group; your name goes on the worlds you shape.
HEADLINE · CTA	Build the first version with us · Sign up
LANDS ON	educators page · utm_content=a3

What it tests: Co-creation: will educators give time to co-design?

LET THEM GET IT WRONG. THEN TRY AGAIN.



Next Billion Children
Sponsored · preview mockup

In a Learning World your child investigates, builds, gets it wrong and tries a...



FOR PARENTS AND FAMILIES
LET THEM GET IT WRONG. THEN TRY AGAIN.

Hands-on learning where your child investigates, builds and explains

Find a programme near you

Let them get it wrong. Then try again.

Learn more

PERSONA	Parents
PLACEMENT	Meta (Facebook and Instagram) feed
PRIMARY TEXT	In a Learning World your child investigates, builds, gets it wrong and tries again, then explains why. You get a short update in their own words. No grades, no rankings.
HEADLINE · CTA	Let them get it wrong. Then try again. · Learn more
LANDS ON	families page · utm_content=a4



What it tests: Agency: do parents value trying again over scores?

SPONSOR A LEARNING ROOM IN CAPE COAST



Next Billion Children
Sponsored · preview mockup

Help a community programme in Cape Coast run hands-on learning where children ...



NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

FOR SPONSORS AND ALUMNI GROUPS

SPONSOR A LEARNING ROOM IN CAPE COAST.

Hands-on learning for a community programme · termly reports, no child identified

Register interest



Sponsor a learning room in Cape Coast

Register

PERSONA	Diaspora sponsors
PLACEMENT	LinkedIn feed
PRIMARY TEXT	Help a community programme in Cape Coast run hands-on learning where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI. Register interest; no payment now.
HEADLINE · CTA	Sponsor a learning room in Cape Coast · Register
LANDS ON	sponsors page · utm_content=a5



What it tests: Belonging: will Ghanaians abroad sponsor a room at home?

THE LANDING PAGES

Every ad lands on a page written for the same person, with one clear next step.

READY TO RUN, WITH A PILOT TO BOOK.

Hero with the offer, three reasons, the eight-week pilot, and a short form about the programme. · full page, read left to right



[Book a pilot conversation](#)

FOR AFTER-SCHOOL AND HOLIDAY PROGRAMMES • AGES 9-12

HANDS-ON LEARNING, READY TO RUN.

Learning Worlds give your programme reusable physical experiences, a facilitator card for every session, and a short evidence summary you can show parents and funders.

[Book a pilot conversation](#)[How it works](#)

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.



Ready on day one

Each 45-minute session fits on one printed card. Any trained facilitator can run it.



Low-cost, reusable kits

Everyday materials and micro:bit, for up to six children per kit.



Evidence you can show

What each child tried, how much help they had, and whether it held in a new task. No scores.

AN EIGHT-WEEK PILOT

01

A 30-minute call about your programme and your children.

02

We set up one Learning World with your facilitators.

03

Your team runs it for eight weeks, with support.

04

You get a short evidence summary and decide what is next.

TALK TO US ABOUT A PILOT

We reply within two working days. No sales sequence, no spam.

Your name

Ama Mensah

Programme or organisation

Saturday Science Club

Town or city

Cape Coast

Children per week (approx.)

40

What would you most like to improve?

[Book a pilot conversation](#)

We only ask about your programme. Your details are used to reply to you and are never sold.



Learning infrastructure for the next billion children. Delivered with Algo Peers, Cape Coast, Ghana.

Prototype landing page · source: ad A1 / A2 · We never collect information about children on this page.



FOR AFTER-SCHOOL AND HOLIDAY PROGRAMMES • AGES 9-12

HANDS-ON LEARNING, READY TO RUN.

Learning Worlds give your programme reusable physical experiences, a facilitator card for every session, and a short evidence summary you can show parents and funders.

[Book a pilot conversation](#)[How it works](#)

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.

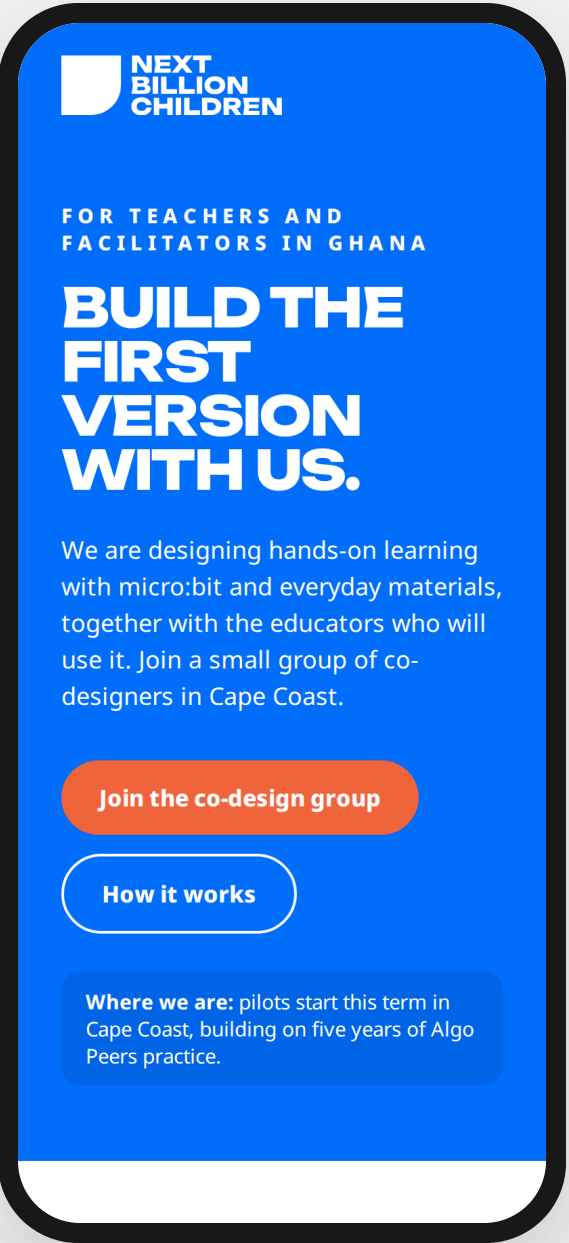
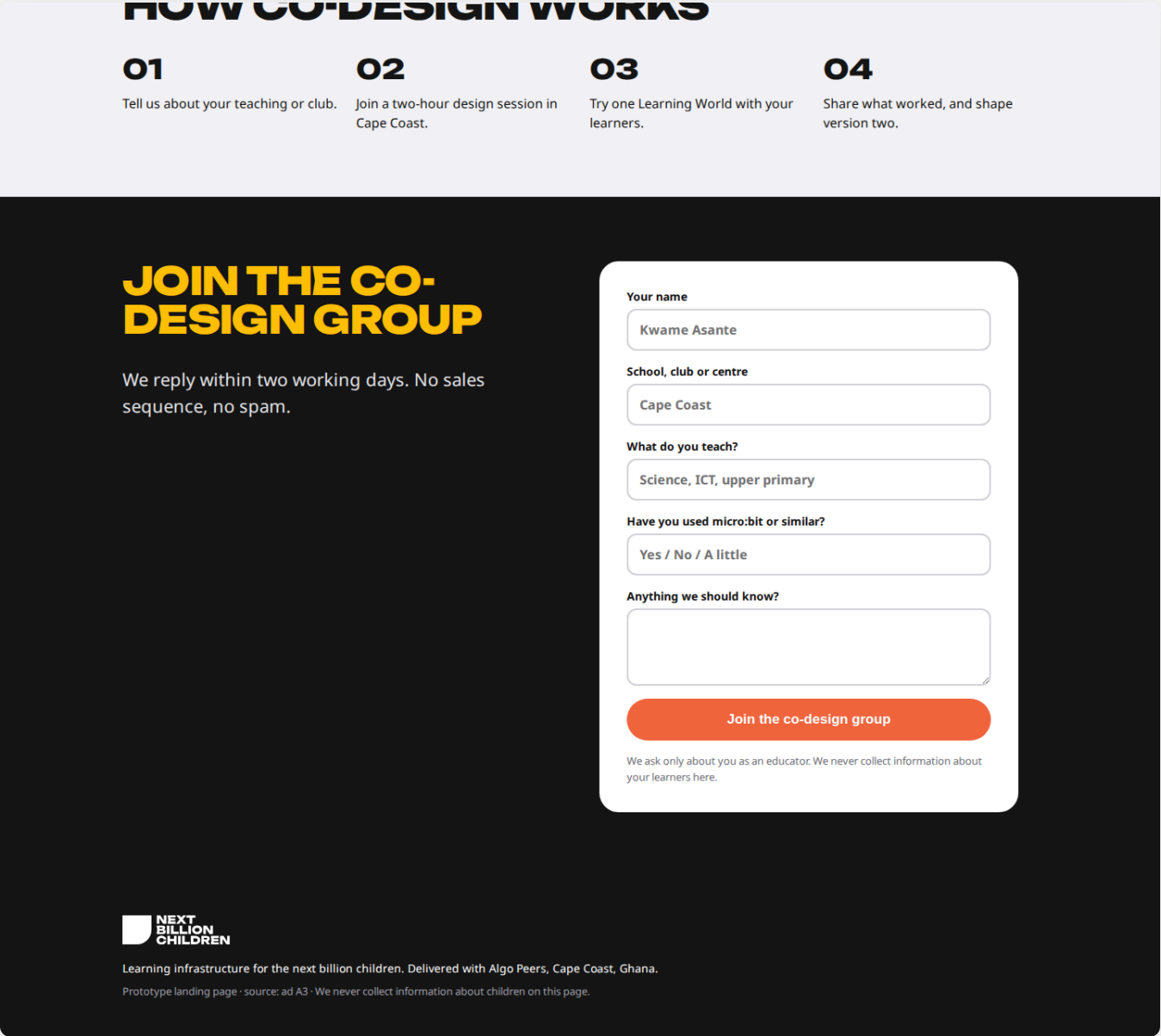
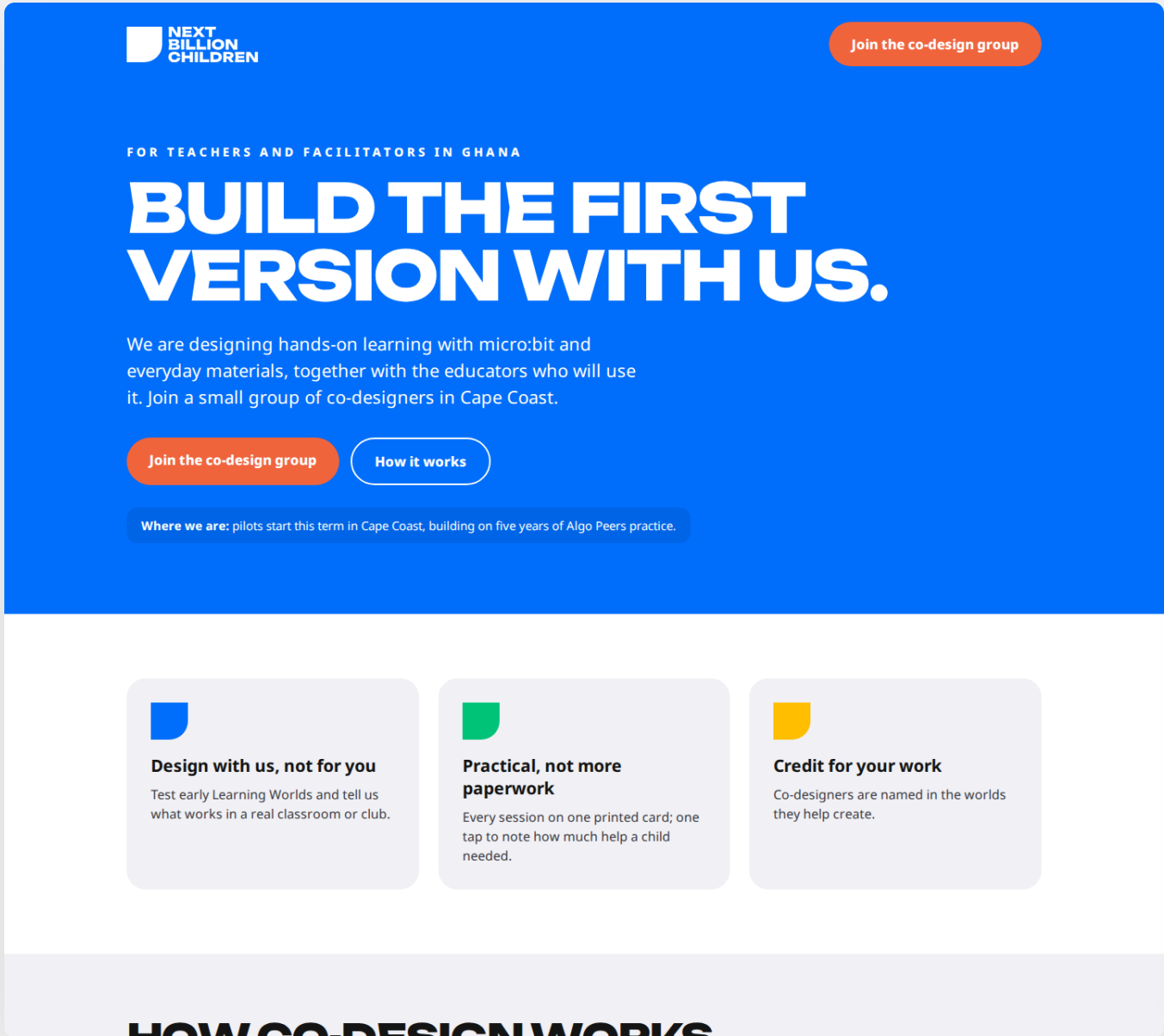
 NBC • Prove it before we scale it • Fall 2026

programmes page · full brand guide

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AN INVITATION TO CO-DESIGN.

Why co-design, how it works in four steps, and a form about the educator, never their learners. • full page, read left to right



TRYING AGAIN, NOT SCORES.

What a session looks like, no rankings, parents stay in control; contact details only. • full page, read left to right



Find a programme near you

FOR PARENTS AND FAMILIES • AGES 9-12

LET THEM GET IT WRONG. THEN TRY AGAIN.

In a Learning World your child investigates, builds, gets it wrong and tries again, then explains what they changed and why. You get a short update, in their own words.

Find a programme near you

How it works

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.



Real things, real thinking

Ramps, plants, circuits and micro:bit: one change at a time, then explain why.



No scores, no rankings

Updates show what your child tried and said, never a grade or a comparison.



You stay in control

You can see, question and correct what is recorded about your child.

WHAT A SESSION LOOKS LIKE

01
Children choose what to change.

02
They predict what will happen.

03
They run it, and look closely.

04
They explain it, and try again.

FIND A PROGRAMME NEAR YOU

We reply within two working days. No sales sequence, no spam.

Your name

Efua Owusu

Phone or email

So we can reply

Town or neighbourhood

Cape Coast

Questions for us

Find a programme near you

We ask only for your contact details. Please do not share your child's name or details here.



Learning infrastructure for the next billion children. Delivered with Algo Peers, Cape Coast, Ghana.

Prototype landing page - source: ad A4 - We never collect information about children on this page.



Find a programme near you

FOR PARENTS AND FAMILIES • AGES 9-12

LET THEM GET IT WRONG. THEN TRY AGAIN.

In a Learning World your child investigates, builds, gets it wrong and tries again, then explains what they changed and why. You get a short update, in their own words.

Find a programme near you

How it works

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.

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families page • full brand guide

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A ROOM AT HOME, REPORTED HONESTLY.

Where the money goes, what sponsors see, who delivers; no payment taken. · full page, read left to right

NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

Register interest

FOR INDIVIDUALS, ALUMNI GROUPS AND ORGANISATIONS

SPONSOR A LEARNING ROOM IN CAPE COAST.

Help a community programme run hands-on learning where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI. Register interest, and we will share a costed sponsorship plan.

Register interest

How it works

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.

Where it goes

Kits, facilitator support and the evidence summary for one programme.

What you see

A short termly report on what the programme ran and learned. No child is ever identified.

Who delivers

Algo Peers' team in Cape Coast, with five years of practice.

HOW SPONSORSHIP WILL WORK

01

Register interest (no payment now).

02

We share a costed plan for one room.

03

You choose a programme and a term.

04

You receive termly reports.

REGISTER INTEREST

We reply within two working days. No sales sequence, no spam.

Your name

Email

Organisation or group (optional)

Country

Register interest

No payment is taken. Sponsorship terms will be shared in writing before any commitment.

NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

Learning infrastructure for the next billion children. Delivered with Algo Peers, Cape Coast, Ghana.

Prototype landing page - source: ad A5 · We never collect information about children on this page.

NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

Register interest

FOR INDIVIDUALS, ALUMNI GROUPS AND ORGANISATIONS

SPONSOR A LEARNING ROOM IN CAPE COAST.

Help a community programme run hands-on learning where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI. Register interest, and we will share a costed sponsorship plan.

Register interest

How it works

Where we are: pilots start this term in Cape Coast, building on five years of Algo Peers practice.

THE SETUP

How each persona becomes an audience a platform can reach.

FROM PERSONA TO AUDIENCE.

PLANNED CONFIGURATION · NOT YET BUILT IN ADS MANAGER

AD SET 1 · PROGRAMME OWNERS

Platform	Meta Ads Manager · Facebook and Instagram feeds
Location	Cape Coast + 40 km; Accra + 25 km
Age	25–60
Detailed targeting	Education, STEM education, child development, small business owners
Ads	A1 and A2, \$20 each, 7 days
Optimise for	Leads (landing-page form)

 **Persona to audience:** runs a programme in Cape Coast or Accra; 25–60; owner or manager

AD SET 2 · EDUCATORS

Platform	Meta Ads Manager · Facebook and Instagram feeds
Location	Central Region and Greater Accra
Age	22–55
Detailed targeting	Teaching, science education, computer science, robotics, micro:bit
Ads	A3, \$20, 7 days · shared with GES Cape Coast first
Optimise for	Leads

 **Persona to audience:** teacher or facilitator; science, ICT or coding club

FROM PERSONA TO AUDIENCE.

AD SET 3 · PARENTS

Platform	Meta Ads Manager · Facebook and Instagram feeds
Location	Cape Coast + 30 km
Age	25–50
Detailed targeting	Parents with preteens (8–12), education
Ads	A4, \$20, 7 days
Optimise for	Landing-page views, then leads

→ **Persona to audience:** parent of a child aged 8–12 in Cape Coast

AD SET 4 · DIASPORA SPONSORS

Platform	LinkedIn Campaign Manager · feed
Location	United States, United Kingdom, Canada
Audience	Members of Ghanaian alumni and professional groups; education philanthropy interest
Seniority	Manager and above
Ads	A5, \$40 (LinkedIn’s higher minimum), 7 days
Optimise for	Lead form or website visits

→ **Persona to audience:** Ghanaian abroad; alumni groups; professionals

BUDGET, TRACKING AND CARE.

BUDGET

Round 1: \$120 (four Meta ads at \$20, the LinkedIn ad at \$40), Wed 14 – Tue 20 Oct.

Round 2: up to \$80, shifted to the winning personas, Wed 21 – Tue 27 Oct.

Total: \$200 or less.

TRACKING

Each ad links with its own UTM tags: source, campaign (nbc-persona-v1) and content (a1–a5).

Sign-ups are counted per page and logged in our CRM as leads, with the ad that brought them.

Qualified = matches the persona on a short follow-up call.

CARE

Adults only: no ad is shown to anyone under 22, and no page asks about a child.

No tracking pixels on the families page.

The educator ad is shared with GES Cape Coast before it runs.

No claims of learning results.

THE RESULTS

The scoreboard is ready. The numbers come when the ads run.

SCOREBOARD V1.

READY FOR REAL NUMBERS.

AD	IMPRESSIONS	LINK CLICKS	CLICK RATE	PAGE VIEWS	SIGN-UPS	COST PER SIGN-UP	QUALIFIED	VERDICT
A1	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
A2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
A3	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
A4	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
A5	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Pass lines: click rate ≥1% (Meta), ≥0.5% (LinkedIn) · sign-ups ≥5% of page views · ≤\$10 per qualified sign-up.

RULES FOR ROUND TWO.

If A persona misses every pass line	Then Drop it from round 2 and move its budget to the leader.
If Clicks are high but sign-ups are low	Then The ad works and the page does not: rewrite the page, keep the ad.
If Clicks are low but sign-ups are high	Then The page works: test a sharper image and first line.
If A1 and A2 differ by 2× or more	Then Keep the winning message and test two new versions of it.
If Educators sign up fast	Then Cap at 20 co-designers; agree the first session with GES Cape Coast.

The five v2 ads are written on Wed 21 Oct from the round 1 numbers, with the same layout and colours, so only the tested variable changes.

SCOREBOARD V2. THEN WE DECIDE.

AD	IMPRESSIONS	LINK CLICKS	CLICK RATE	PAGE VIEWS	SIGN-UPS	COST PER SIGN-UP	QUALIFIED	VERDICT
v2-1	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
v2-2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
v2-3	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
v2-4	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
v2-5	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

Tue 27 Oct decision: which persona and message lead our pilot offer, our next meetings and the GES proposal. **Pass lines:** click rate ≥1% (Meta), ≥0.5% (LinkedIn) · sign-ups ≥5% of page views · ≤\$10 per qualified sign-up.

THE PLAYBOOK

Why this matters, and how we built it.

HOW IT SERVES THE BUSINESS

SPEND A LITTLE. LEARN WHO BUYS.

\$200 of ads tells us which persona and message to put first in every pilot offer, meeting and proposal, before we spend months on the wrong buyer.

BUILT IN EIGHT MOVES

01 Turned interview hypotheses into four personas.

02 Mapped each persona to one meeting door or ad set.

03 Wrote five ads, one variable per split.

04 Designed them in the brand, as square images.

05 Built four matching landing pages.

06 Planned audiences, budget and UTM tracking.

07 Set pass lines and round-two rules in advance.

08 Booked a creative review with Jeff D. Davis before launch.

WHERE IT GOES NEXT

BUILT ON RESEARCH. READY TO SCALE.

FROM RESEARCH TO REACH.

Market research gave us the buyer and the problem; the identity gave us the look. These ads put both in front of real people.

A MACHINE FOR EVERY WORLD.

Each new Learning World or town reuses the same persona sets, pages and pass lines. Only the creative changes.

EVIDENCE FOR EVERY DOOR.

Real demand data strengthens the GES proposal, the ministry conversation and our accelerator and fellowship applications.

MEANWHILE

What else moved.

AN IDENTITY, AND A STORY THAT MOVES.

- Published "An identity that sticks": the logo, colour, type and voice system, both website versions, the social kit and the email signature.
- Released a 62-second [motion story](#) with an original score, in the brand.

THE RIGHT ROOMS.

- Met Ghana's Minister of Communication and Digital Innovation at the Harvard Kennedy School.
- Our Ghana team met the Director of GES Cape Coast; an MOU for pilot testing is being explored. None is signed yet.
- Meeting Jeff D. Davis on Tue 6 Oct; a meeting with Dr Ekwow Spio-Garbrah is being scheduled through an advisory board member.

INVITED, APPLIED, AND RECOGNISED.

- **Navab Social Innovation Fellowship:** invited to interview.
- **TNT accelerator:** \$200,000 pre-seed for 2.5% equity; decision pending.
- **Founder:** Sam Quansah is a Mandela Washington Fellow.

THE NEXT FOUR WEEKS.

WEEK 3

7 – 13 Oct

Meetings; creative review; pages hosted

Ads ready to launch

WEEK 4

14 – 20 Oct

Ads round 1; offers to 10 owners

Tue 20 Oct: 10 offers out

WEEK 5

21 – 27 Oct

Ads round 2; GES pilot proposal

Tue 27 Oct: lead persona chosen

WEEK 6

28 Oct – 3 Nov

Pilot set-up with first programmes

MOU and first pilot dates

Weeks run Wednesday to Tuesday. Dates after Tue 20 Oct are plans.



LEARNING INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE NEXT BILLION CHILDREN.

TALK TO US

Sam Quansah

Founder · Mandela Washington Fellow

samquansah@gse.harvard.edu

samquans@mit.edu

THE CAMPAIGN

[Ads, pages and plan](#)

[Full brand guide \(PDF\)](#)

[Motion story](#)

